



Old Bridge Township School District

Curriculum & Instruction Department

Course: 7th Grade ELA Honors

Department: English/Language Arts

Term: Full Year

Board Approval	Committee Members	Supervisor	Notes
9/24/2024	Alana Greenwood	Rocco Celentano	Grade 7, Jonas Salk Middle School

MISSION STATEMENT

Recognizing that each person has an inherent worth, it is the mission of the Old Bridge Public Schools to empower each student to learn to achieve success and to become a confident, productive member of a pluralistic, global society prepared to face the challenges of the 21st Century.

BELIEFS

- Learning is a lifelong process.
- All children can learn.
- Education is a shared responsibility among the schools, the child, the family, and the community.
- All students are entitled to a safe, supportive learning environment.
- Self-esteem is necessary for successful learning.
- The development of curriculum is an ongoing and cyclical process.
- The district should provide a dynamic curriculum that recognizes our students' various needs and learning styles.
- An appreciation of the arts and humanities enhances the education of the whole child.
- All students should be taught to appreciate and respect the cultural differences in our society.
- All students are worthy of educational opportunity, respect, tolerance, and fairness.
- Schools should prepare students to function successfully in society.
- All children should be encouraged to rise to their highest level of achievement.

AFFIRMATIVE ACTION STATEMENT

The Old Bridge Township Public Schools provides equal educational opportunities for all students, including equal access to all school facilities, programs, equipment, staff services, financial resources, courses, or activities, and other benefits regardless of race, color, creed, religion, sex, ancestry, national origin, social, economic or academic status or physical handicap.

PHILOSOPHY

The Old Bridge Township Public School District's Honors English Language Arts (ELA) Program provides students with authentic, meaningful experiences that will enable students to grow and develop intellectually, emotionally, and socially. Instructional practices are student-centered, promoting a commitment to life-long learning by developing and enriching students' speaking, listening, writing, reading, representative, and viewing skills, particularly on a more independent scale. The role of the honors teacher is to provide bridges between what students already know, what they can do, and what they need to know and do in a challenging honors setting. The teacher establishes a language-

rich, interactive environment that provides strong support for literacy learning and surrounds the children with a wide variety of high-quality literature.

The ELA Program utilizes a balanced approach to literacy, integrating reading, writing, speaking, and listening throughout the curriculum. Reading comprehension is essential to continuing intellectual development. In addition, the Old Bridge Middle School ELA program requires the incorporation of research and comprehension strategies. Key to the development of reading comprehension is a sequence of activities known as the "gradual release of responsibility," which is accelerated compared to their mid-level peers.

Differentiated instruction recognizes and supports individual learning styles, developmental readiness, and cultural differences, enabling all students to experience success. Library and research skills are integral to student experiences in all grade levels. Through integrated language experiences, students will strive to become independent readers, writers, and critical thinkers. Most importantly, students will acquire the skills to "read to learn," which is essential for becoming lifelong learners and independent writers.

PREFACE

Reading	• The standards require the progressive development of reading comprehension so that students advancing through the grades can gain more from whatever they read. • Through reading a diverse array of classic and contemporary literature, as well as challenging informational texts in a range of subjects, students are expected to build knowledge, gain insights, explore possibilities, and broaden their perspective. • The standards mandate certain critical types of content for all students, including classic myths and stories from around the world, foundational U.S. documents, seminal works of American literature, and current events.
Writing	• The ability to write logical arguments based on substantive claims, sound reasoning, and relevant evidence is a cornerstone of the writing standards, with opinion writing-a basic form of argument-extending down into the earliest grades. • Research: both short, focused projects (such as those commonly required in the workplace) and longer-term in-depth research is emphasized throughout the standards but most prominently in the writing strand since a written analysis and presentation of findings is so often critical.

Speaking and Listening	• The standards require the students gain, evaluate, and present increasingly complex information, ideas, and evidence through listening and speaking as well as through media. • An important focus of the speaking and listening standards is academic discussion in one-on-one, small-group, and whole-class settings. Formal presentations are one important way such talk occurs, but so is the more informal discussion that takes place as students collaborate to answer questions, build understanding, and solve problems.
Language	• The standards expect that students will grow their vocabularies through a mix of conversations, direct instruction, and reading. • The standards recognize that students must be able to use formal English in their writing and speaking but that they must also be able to make informed, skillful choices among the many ways to express themselves through language. • Vocabulary and conventions are treated in their own strand not because skills in these areas should be handled in isolation but because their use extends across reading, writing, speaking, and listening.
Media and Technology	• Just as media and technology are integrated in school and life in the twenty-first century, skills related to media use (both critical analysis and production of media) are integrated throughout the standards.

Old Bridge Pacing Calendar

Marking Period 1		Marking Period 2	
Reading and Analyzing Elements of Literature and Narrative Writing		Poetry and Drama Literary Analysis	
1	Narrative Text Structure (plot, central ideas, characterization, theme development)	1	Poetry—craft and structure, figurative language, symbolism, theme, sound devices
2	Summarizing and Close-Reading	2	Elements of Drama—stage directions, dialogue, literary devices (allusion, flashback, foreshadowing, irony, symbolism, etc.
3	Open-Ended Responses (OERs) and Paragraph Structure	3	Five-Paragraph Essay Structure (including thesis writing, direct citation, MLA formatting)
4	Original Text-Based Narrative Construction (short stories) – plot, imagery, dialogue, figurative language	4	Theme Development Essays—determining themes and tracking development throughout text; author’s purpose
		5	Compare and Contrast Analysis of multiple characters, themes, texts, structures, etc.

Marking Period 3		Marking Period 4	
Informational Text Analysis & Research		Cumulative Review and Comparison of All Genres	
1	Informational Text Structures & Reading Comprehension	1	Fiction and Non-Fiction Compare and Contrast
2	Citing Multiple Sources (MLA Format)	2	Theme Development
3	Summary Writing, Paraphrasing & Avoiding Plagiarism	3	Literary Analysis Revisited
4	Research Papers (Informational Essays Utilizing Multiple Sources)	4	Informational Text Analysis Revisited
5	Argumentative Essays and Debates Utilizing Research, Claims and Counterclaims	5	MLA Format and Works Cited

Core Instructional Resources and Materials (Including Varied Levels of Text)

- StudySync ELA Grade 7. McGraw Hill. 2015 (one class set of 30 textbooks per teacher)
- <https://connected.mcgraw-hill.com/connected/dashboard.do> StudySync online access per teacher and per student.
- McDougal Littell, ed. *Literature*. Evanston, IL: McDougal, 2008. Print.
- Hiranandani, Veera. *The Whole Story of Half a Girl*. Yearling. 2013.
- Zindel, Paul. *The Pigman*. New York: HarperTrophy, 2005. Print.
- Lowry, Lois. *The Giver*. Clarion Books; Reprint edition (July 1, 2014)
- Gibson, William. *The Miracle Worker; and Related Readings*. Evanston, IL: McDougal Littell, 1998. Print.
- L'Engle, Madeleine. *A Wrinkle in Time*: Square Fish; Reprint edition 2007. Print.
- Christie, Agatha. *And Then There Were None*. New York: Harper, 2011. Print.
- Shostak, Jerome. *Sadlier-Oxford Vocabulary Workshop New Edition Level B*. New ed. New York, NY: William H. Sadlier, 2005. Print.
- <https://www.ixl.com/ela/grade-7> IXL Grade 7 - various activities; one login per student and teacher
- [IXL Skill Alignment | NJSLA | 7th grade](#)
- Poetry Foundation <https://www.poetryfoundation.org/>
- <https://nj.testnav.com> Grade 7 Units 1-3

PLEASE NOTE: Any resource or material that falls outside of the approved lists included within the curriculum document must have administrative approval prior to use. These resources or materials must also be noted in the teacher's lesson plan after approval is granted.

Unit # 1	Duration (1 Marking Period)
Topic: Elements of Literature and Narrative Writing	
Alignment to NJSLs (include practice standards)	
● L.SS.7.1. ● L.KL.7.2. ● L.VL.7.3. ● L.VI.7.4. ● RL.CR.7.1. ● RL.CI.7.2. ● RL.PP.7.5. ● W.AW.7.1. ● W.NW.7.3. ● W.WP.7.4. ● W.RW.7.7.	

- SL.PE.7.1.
- SL.AS.7.6.

Technology, Career Awareness, and 21st Century Standards (NJSLS 9)

8.1.8.CS.4: Systematically apply troubleshooting strategies to identify and resolve hardware and software problems in computing systems.

8.1.8.DA.1: Organize and transform data collected using computational tools to make it usable for a specific purpose.

9.4.8.DC.1: Analyze the resource citations in online materials for proper use.

9.4.8.DC.2: Provide appropriate citation and attribution elements when creating media products (e.g., W.6.8).

Interdisciplinary Standards

RH.6-8.6. Identify aspects of a text that reveal an author's point of view or purpose (e.g., loaded language, inclusion or avoidance of particular facts).

Curriculum Requirements (N.J.A.C. 6A:8, 6A:30)

SL.II.7.2. Analyze the main ideas and supporting details presented in diverse media and formats (e.g., visually, quantitatively, orally) and explain how the ideas clarify a topic, text, or issue under study.

Learning Objectives and Activities

SWBAT answer the following questions:

- How does understanding narrative text structure improve our ability to analyze a story's meaning?
- How does close-reading help us identify and summarize the main ideas of stories?
- How does making, correcting, and confirming predictions help improve reading comprehension?
- What are the fundamental differences between topic, moral, and theme?
- How do topics correlate to themes?
- How can readers distinguish between *a* theme versus *the* theme?
- How does identifying and analyzing character motivation help improve our holistic comprehension?
- How does setting interact with other story elements: character, plot, theme?
- How do settings create conflict for characters and plot?
- How can determining connotative and denotative meanings strength comprehension?
- How do authors use connotative meanings to emphasize their purpose and point of view?
- What is the importance of identifying, classifying, and analyzing the use of figurative language in narratives?
- How do film versions compare and contrast to written stories?
- How does summarizing chronologically ordered textual evidence strengthen literary analysis?
- How does citing textual evidence support analysis and reflection?
- Why are narrative elements: *plot, imagery, dialogue, and figurative language*, important for writing strong text-based original stories?
- How do the development of sensory details and imagery in narrative writing add to the richness of the text?
- What elements do narrative authors use to craft point of view?
- How do authors develop and contrast the point of view of the narrator from the other characters?
- How do narrative authors develop effective hooks?
- What techniques can be used to provide a reflective narrative conclusion?

SWBAT demonstrate understanding of the following:

Narrative Analysis

- Elements of Fiction
- Narrative Text Structure
- Reading Comprehension
- Close Reading Strategies
- Annotating
- Plot
- Characterization
- Setting (Direct/Indirect)
- Conflict
- Connotation/Denotation
- Visualizing
- Making and Monitoring Predictions
- Point of View/Narration
- Summarizing literal central ideas
- Chronological Order
- Making Inferences
- Determining and analyzing meanings of figurative language
- Identify and analyze elements of style: word choice, imagery, and dialogue
- Collaborative Conversations

Open-Ended Response

- Kinds of sentences
- Fragments, Complete Sentences, run-ons
- Simple and Compound Sentences
- Punctuating and Capitalizing Titles
- Mechanics
- Paragraph Structure
- Topic sentence
- Supporting Details
- Transitioning/Clauses
- Commas
- Cited Textual Evidence
- Punctuating In-Text Citations
- Extended Explanation/Analysis
- Restate/Concluding Statement
- MLA format
- Peer Review

- Genre Analysis/Text Dependent Responses

Text-Based Narratives

- The Writing Process
- Planning and drafting narrative sequence
- Dialogue
- Punctuating Dialogue
- Narration
- Setting development
- Transitioning
- Sensory Details/Imagery
- Incorporating relevant text-based details
- Figurative Language
- Characterization
- Reflective Conclusions
- Peer analysis and constructive feedback

Learning Activities:

Reading and Analyzing Narratives

- Identify and analyze narrative text structure, elements of plot
- Annotate close reading responses, to ask questions, track information, and respond to/interact with the text
- Analyze how characters interact with other story elements: settings and plot.
- Identify and analyze how character motivation interacts with other story elements
- Discover and trace the development of topics, morals, and themes, as well as make sound inferences, and predictions in literature
- Summarize literal and inferential central ideas in chronological order
- Select accurate pieces of textual evidence to illustrate claim validity
- Articulate events that are central to plot
- Use context clues such as definition, comparison, contrast, and examples to clarify the meanings of words.
- Develop appropriate vocabulary and grammar for grade level

Open-Ended Responses

- analyze central ideas of prompts
- use the writing process and RABCE or TEAL to craft a short-constructed response
- establish and maintain a clear focus and flow in written expression by using RABCE (restate, answer, background, cite, explain, recap) and the writing process to develop responses to open-ended questions
- introduce/build on knowledge of paragraph structure: MLA format (signal phrase and parenthetical citations), topic sentence, supporting details, transitions, concluding statements/restatements
- Use MLA to format in-text citations
- close read, highlight main ideas, and annotate prompts to gain clear understanding of what is specifically being asked

- complete plans for organized writing using a variety of graphic organizers
- gather and classify textual evidence
- determine appropriate pieces of text to directly justify claims
- summarize central ideas in chronological order
- write short answer responses to open-ended questions that follow MLA format and include a clear thesis/topic sentence/answer and expanded explanation using relative, specific cited textual evidence
- Cite pieces of evidence to support analysis, explicit and inferential
- rainbow edit writing for introduction, thesis, support (cited textual evidence and inferences) format, transitions, conclusion
- routinely write short answer responses and allot time for reflection of strengths and weaknesses as well as peer and teacher feedback
- use grade level and/or above level vocabulary and grammar in written responses

Planning and Writing Text-Based Narratives:

- Plan, draft, revise and edit elements of narrative structure
- write narrative hooks
- demonstrate normative dialogue structure
- compose narratives that thoughtfully include text-based details of characterization, setting, figurative language, point-of-view, and logical plot development.
- use and evenly distribute descriptive details: sensory details, imagery, characterization
- plan and executing plot structure conflict/resolution around a central idea/theme
- incorporate appropriate use of grade-level modifiers, phrases, and clauses
- appropriately identify, classify and incorporate text-based elements to develop characters, setting(s), and plot
- write reflective conclusions that draw from the main character's experience

Grammar:

- sentence structure
- commas
- punctuation
- pronoun-antecedent
- verb-tense agreement
- varied kinds of sentences

Vocabulary:

- Context clues
- Connotation/denotation
- Word parts
- Synonyms/antonyms

Suggested Study Sync Units

- Selected Stories from Units 1-2

Suggested Novels

- *A Wrinkle in Time*
- *And Then There Were None*
- *The Whole Story of Half a Girl*
- *The Giver*
- *The Pigman*

Suggested IXL Lessons

- B.1-2 Theme
- C. 1-3 Author's Purpose
- D.1 Author's Perspective
- F.1, 4-6 Literary Devices
- G.1-3 Analyzing Literature
- J.1-4 Novel Study
- P.1-3 Descriptive and Creative Writing
- Q.2 Identifying Text Evidence
- R.3 Writing Clearly and Concisely
- S.1-5 Editing and Revising
- T.3-5 Research Skills (MLA)
- Y.1-2 Word Choice and Usage
- AA.1-4 Context Clues
- DD.1-7 Sentences, Fragments, Run-ons
- GG.1-5 Pronouns and Antecedents
- RR.2-5 Commas
- VV.1-2,4 Formatting

Benchmark, Formative, Summative and Alternative Assessments

- **Reading and Analyzing a Literary Text:**
 - **Evidence-Based Selected Response Study Sync End-of-Unit - Grade 7 - Unit 1:** Students will close read multiple choice questions and possible answer choices, literal and inferential claims and pieces of cited textual evidence, to conclude accurate text-based selections. Questions will focus on narrative text structure/plot, setting, characterization, conflict, point of view, narration, topics, morals, and themes, figurative language and vocabulary in context.
- **Written Expression Formal Assessments:**
 - **Open-Ended Questions:** Students will write multiple, cohesive open-ended responses about narratives that use appropriate textual evidence and extended explanation(s) to support their thesis/answer. Scoring: Assignment-based rubrics

- **Text-Based Narratives:** Given multiple narrative excerpts, students will prewrite, draft, and publish narrative essays that illustrate appropriate genre-specific structure and dialogue, as well as sensory and accurate text-based details while maintaining a clear focus and flow according to the anchor text's plot and theme. Scoring: Assignment-based rubric.

- **Summative:**

- Quizzes, Short-Answer Questions
- Tests & Essays
- Group Presentations

- **Formative:**

- Classwork and Homework
- IXL Practice
- Teacher Observation
- Class Discussion and Checks for Understanding
- Close-Reading and Annotating

Unit # 2	Duration (1 Marking Period)
Topic: Poetry and Drama Literary Analysis	
Alignment to NJSLS (include practice standards)	
● L.SS.7.1. ● L.KL.7.2. ● L.VI.7.4. ● RL.CR.7.1. ● RL.CI.7.2. ● RL.IT.7.3. ● RL.TS.7.4. ● RL.PP.7.5. ● RL.MF.7.6. ● RL.CT.7.8. ● W.AW.7.1. ● W.WP.7.4. ● W.RW.7.7. ● SL.PE.7.1. ● SL.II.7.2. ● SL.PI.7.4. ● SL.AS.7.6.	
Technology, Career Awareness, and 21 st Century Standards (NJSLS 9)	

9.4.5.CT.1: Identify and gather relevant data that will aid in the problem-solving process (e.g., 2.1.5.EH.4, 4-ESS3-1, 6.3.5.CivicsPD.2).

8.1.8.DA.3: Identify the appropriate tool to access data based on its file format.

Interdisciplinary Standards

9.4.5.IML.1: Evaluate digital sources for accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance (e.g., Social Studies Practice - Gathering and Evaluating Sources).

Curriculum Requirements (N.J.A.C. 6A:8, 6A:30)

9.4.8.DC.1: Analyze the resource citations in online materials for proper use.

Learning Objectives and Activities

SWBAT answer the following questions:

- How do dramatic elements and structure contribute to the meaning and theme of the play?
- How does the use of literary devices in drama and poetry help readers develop a holistic understanding of structure and themes?
- How do the use of figurative language and sound devices in poetry shape its theme?
- How do the dramatic elements of a play contribute to its overall impact and meaning?
- How does using five-paragraph essay structure help to demonstrate our understanding of a text?
- How can knowledge of sentence kinds help writers construct exceptional thesis statements of theme?
- How can readers track, analyze, and use a character's journey through the plot of a drama or narrative poem to identify and explain the development of multiple themes?
- How do authors develop and contrast the points of view of characters in a drama?
- How do poets develop and contrast the points of view of the speaker and different subjects in poems?
- How can adjusting fluency strengthen comprehension?
- What is the impact of sound devices used in specific stanzas of a poem?
- How do the use of rhyme, rhythm, repetition, symbolism, and allusions develop the speaker's perspective?
- How does identifying and analyzing setting, characters, and conflict help readers articulate a drama or poem's plot and theme?
- How does having superior structural command lead to accurate identification of textual support to illustrate claims?
- How can readers distinguish the central idea of a drama or poem through analysis of text structure?
- How can tracking the development of a theme throughout a text deepen our understanding of the text's message?
- How do film versions or media adaptations compare and contrast to written texts?
- How can comparing elements of a text help us understand an author's purpose?
- How are authors of different genres able to develop similar themes in ways that compare and contrast?

SWBAT demonstrate understanding of the following:

Poetry

- Craft and Structure of Poetry
- Genre-specific terms
- Literary Devices
- Central Idea in Poetry
- Determining Poetic Themes

- Sound Devices
- Graphic Elements
- Fluency
- Structural Analysis

Text-based Narrative (Poetic Anchor)

- Tracing central ideas in poetry
- Planning and drafting a text-based narrative that demonstrate holistic comprehension of central ideas in a poem
- Incorporating unique, sophisticated figurative language, literary devices, and vocabulary that correlate to anchor text

Literary Analysis of Poetic Elements and Structure

- Comparing and Contrasting the Development of Poetic Themes
- Development of Point-of-View
- Five-Paragraph Expository Essay Structure
- Paragraph Structure (Introduction, bodies, conclusion)
- Hooks
- Thesis Writing
- In-text citations (MLA)
- Works Cited

DRAMA:

- Identify and explain genre-specific terms (ex: stage directions, dialogue, etc.)
- Identify and explain literary device terms and examples in context: allusion, flashback, foreshadowing, irony, and symbolism.
- Determine universal themes and track their development in the text
- Character Motivation
- Setting Interaction
- Plot development
- Mood

Text-based Narrative (Drama Anchor)

- Identify and incorporate appropriate characters, setting(s), plot, and theme to plan and draft a drama based on a narrative excerpt.
- Demonstrate norms and format of dramatic structure when crafting a text-based drama
- Use appropriate grade-level terms, figurative language and/or literary devices as well as varied sentence structure within writing

Literary Analysis of Dramatic Theme

- Given a drama, students will construct a multi-paragraph explanatory essay which identifies and illustrates the development of its theme using multiple direct citations and chronologically ordered summaries of specific scenes as evidence to their claims.

Grammar:

- sentence structure
- commas
- redundancy
- punctuation

Vocabulary:

- Context clues
- Connotation/denotation
- Word parts
- Synonyms/antonyms

Learning Activities:

- Poetry Analysis
- Narrative Poetry
- Review and give notes on mood, tone, word choice, style, form, sound devices, graphic elements, narration, topic, and theme development in poetry
- Analyze the development and structure of various genres of poetry through close reading and annotating.
- Identify, classify and analyze the use of sound devices as they contribute to holistic meaning
- Identify, classify and analyze the use of graphic elements as they contribute to holistic meaning
- Drama Analysis
- Review and give notes on dramatic elements and genre-specific terms and literary devices
- Analyze and explain stage directions interact with other dramatic elements and contribute to central ideas
- Identify, classify and analyze the use of figurative language and literary devices in poetry and drama
- Illustrate knowledge of theme development through poetic and dramatic elements
- Use text-based evidence to explain central ideas in various forms of poetry and drama
- Give an oral interpretation of a poem
- Create text-based narratives from poems and dramas
- Fluency Poem Presentation
- Use graphic organizers to classify and analyze structural elements of poetry and drama
- Make thematic connections between poetry and narrative, and drama
- Discuss elements of explanatory (expository) essay writing (introductions and thesis writing, body paragraphs, conclusions) by showing examples and writing as a class, in groups, and as individuals.
- Review topic sentence writing for body paragraphs, emphasizing that each matches thesis statement (writing focus and flow) which reflects writing prompt.
- Review usage of strong citations supporting topic sentences and thesis.
- Introduce how to properly cite multiple sources using MLA format for future usage of parenthetical citations and student-created works cited pages.
- Teach students how to create and differentiate between simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences to help their writing sound more mature and avoid fragments (by correctly identifying independent and dependent clauses)
- Group Essays and Presentations

Suggested Study Sync Units

- Parts of Units 2, 4 and 6

Suggested IXL Lessons

- 8.B.1. Match the quotations with their themes
- 8.B.2. Determine the themes of short stories

- 8.C.1. Identify author's purpose
- 8.C.D. Determine the author's point of view
- 7.F. 2-3 Literary devices
- 8.F.1-6 Literary Devices
- 7.G.4. Label the rhyme scheme
- 7 M.1 Visual Elements
- 7.N.1-3. Expository Writing
- 7.O.2. Identify thesis statements
- 7.O.3. Choose evidence to support a claim
- 7.Q.2 Identify supporting details in literary texts
- 7.EE. 1-5 Phrases and clauses

Benchmark, Formative, Summative and Alternative Assessments

Reading and Analyzing a Literary Text:

- **Evidence-Based Selected Response Study Sync End-of-Unit - Grade 7 - Unit 2:** Students will close read multiple choice questions and possible answer choices, literal and inferential claims and pieces of cited textual evidence, to conclude accurate text-based selections. Questions will focus on poetic and dramatic text structure.

Open-Ended Responses:

- Given a poem, students will analyze how a poet's use of graphic elements develops a central idea in text.
- Given a poem and a multimedia version, students will analyze how a poet used sound devices and literary devices to help readers understand the speaker's point-of-view and how the multimedia version used light and sound to emphasize these same feelings?
- Given an excerpt from a drama, students will identify and analyze how the use of figurative language in a scene communicates a central idea.

Literary Analysis

- Given a drama and a poem, students will compare and contrast the development of similar themes in a well-constructed five-paragraph essay that uses appropriate in-text citations and includes an MLA formatted Works Cited page.

Summative:

- Quizzes
- Tests and Essays

Formative:

- Classwork and Homework
- IXL Practice
- Teacher Observation
- Class Discussion
- Checks for Understanding
- Close-Reading and Annotating

- Peer Editing and Revising Using Rubrics

Unit # 3	Duration (1 Marking Period)
Topic: Informational Text Analysis and Research	
Alignment to NJSLS (include practice standards)	
• L.SS.7.1. • L.KL.7.2. • L.VL.7.3. • RI.CR.7.1. • RI.CI.7.2. • RI.IT.7.3. • RI.TS.7.4. • RI.PP.7.5. • RI.AA.7.7. • W.AW.7.1. • W.IW.7.2. • W.WP.7.4. • W.WR.7.5. • W.SE.7.6. • W.RW.7.7. • SL.PE.7.1. • SL.II.7.2. • SL.ES.7.3. • SL.PI.7.4. • SL.UM.7.5. • SL.AS.7.6.	
Technology, Career Awareness, and 21st Century Standards (NJSLS 9)	
• 9.4.8.CT.1: Evaluate diverse solutions proposed by a variety of individuals, organizations, and/or agencies to a local or global problem, such as climate change, and use critical thinking skills to predict which one(s) are likely to be effective (e.g., MS-ETS1-2). • 8.1.8.DA.1: Organize and transform data collected using computational tools to make it usable for a specific purpose. • 9.4.8.DC.8: Explain how communities use data and technology to develop measures to respond to effects of climate change (e.g., smart cities).	
Interdisciplinary Standards	
• RST.6-8.1 Cite specific textual evidence to support analysis of science and technical texts, attending to the precise details of explanations or descriptions (MS-PS1-2), (MS-PS1-3)	

- **WHST.6-8.7** Conduct short research projects to answer a question (including a self-generated question), drawing on several sources and generating additional related, focused questions that allow for multiple avenues of exploration. (MS-PS1-6)

Curriculum Requirements (N.J.A.C. 6A:8, 6A:30)

SL.II.7.2. Analyze the main ideas and supporting details presented in diverse media and formats (e.g., visually, quantitatively, orally) and explain how the ideas clarify a topic, text, or issue under study.

W.SE.7.6. Gather relevant information from multiple print and digital sources, using search terms effectively; assess the credibility and accuracy of each source; and quote or paraphrase the data and conclusions of others while avoiding plagiarism and following a standard format for citation. Climate Change Example: Students may determine the credibility of multiple digital and print data sources that can be used as supporting evidence in constructing a model for describing the cycling of water through Earth's systems driven by energy from the sun and the force of gravity.

Learning Objectives and Activities

SWBAT answer the following questions:

- How does our understanding of text structure aid in our interpretation of informational text?
- How can using text features guide a reader's attention to central ideas?
- How can identifying and analyzing the characteristics of rhetorical devices and evidence aid in comprehension of informational texts?
- What impact does tone have on readers of information?
- How do writers of information express their points of view?
- What is the impact of language and style on meaning and tone when writing to a specific audience?
- What is the value of summarizing central ideas and analyzing language, style, and intended audience when participating in collaborative conversations or in a written response?
- How does exploring background information and researching links about a topic help readers develop a richer understanding of texts?
- Why should we compare and contrast a fictional portrayal of a time and place to a historical account of the same time period?
- How do authors of fiction use or alter history?
- When do writing responses require more than one direct citation?
- How can we avoid plagiarism when paraphrasing informational text?
- How is citing from multiple sources an effective way to support our claims?
- How do authors of arguments develop and support central claims and opposing viewpoints?
- Can using text features strengthen arguments?
- How does using counterclaims in argumentative writing help strengthen our arguments?
- How can we assess whether an author's reasoning is sound and his/her evidence is relevant?
- What is bias in arguments, and how can it influence a reader?
- What claims, reasons, and evidence can be used to support an argument in collaborative conversation and written expression?
- What effects do techniques used in audio versions of written speeches have on tone and meaning?
- What is the importance of word choice on meaning and tone of informational or argumentative texts?
- How can we synthesize information to ensure understanding and gain information?
- How do two or more authors writing about the same topic shape their publications of key information?
- How do two or more authors writing about the same topic use different evidence or provide different interpretations of facts?
- In what ways can print, audio, and video work together to present and clarify a topic, text, or issue?
- How can media enhance ideas and topics?
- What impact does making connections to personal experiences, ideas in other texts, and society have on reading comprehension?

- How can using word parts (prefix, root, suffix) help us determine the meaning of words?

SWBAT demonstrate understanding of the following:

- Informational Text Structures: *Chronological Order, Problem-Solution, Compare and Contrast, Cause and Effect, and Sequential*
- Text-Features: *Subheadings, font, bold, italics, underline, charts, graphs, photos, captions, diagrams*
- Author's Purpose and Point of View
- Tone
- Language, Style, Audience
- Reasons and Evidence
- Media
- Generating Questions
- Textual Evidence
- Synthesizing
- Technical Language
- Greek and Latin Roots
- Prefix/Suffix
- Differentiating Between Main Ideas, Supporting Details, and Extraneous Information
- Credible vs Non-Credible Source Differentiation
- Biography/Autobiography
- Summary Writing
- Outline Writing
- Paraphrasing and Avoiding Plagiarism
- Transition Words/Phrases
- Research Simulation Writing
- Arguments and Claims
- Supporting Claims
- Claims vs Counterclaims vs Rebuttals
- Debate Strategies
- Argumentative Essay Writing Process
- Group Debates
- Socratic Questioning and Discussion
- Persuasive vs Argumentative Writing

Learning Activities:

Informational Text: Reading Comprehension

- Introduce informational text structures and text features
- Model how to use text structure and features to distinguish central ideas from supporting details.
- Review how to differentiate between credible and non-credible sources and the difference between fact and opinion. Track author's purpose.
- Identify meanings of words and phrases in a text and the impact of word choice on meaning and tone.

- Provide non-fiction texts paired with works of fiction, particularly novels, that provide historical context, background information, author's purpose, or thematic support.

Summary Writing of Informational Text

- Using various informational texts, review ways to differentiate between information that is most important (primary supporting details) and secondary or extraneous detail
- Introduce formal outline writing using standard format (roman numerals, letters, numbers, etc) using short texts or cross-curricular articles supporting social studies and / or science topics.
- Use parenthetical citations to keep track of where info is coming from.
- Review summary writing using important evidence only. Show the difference between paraphrase, direct citation, and plagiarism while using parenthetical citations in MLA format. Have students use their outlines to help guide their writing.
- Have students create short summaries of various non-fiction texts, first in isolation, then across multiple texts by emphasizing importance of topic sentences and paraphrasing important info that supports the overall main idea of texts. Again, use outlines to help organize and keep track of info and incorporate parenthetical citations.

Research Papers (Informational Essay Writing)

- Review proper usage of transition words and specific vocabulary, paying close attention to sentence structure and grammar usage. (Types of Sentences: simple, compound, complex sentences).
- Using the parts of the writing process previously reviewed (see above), give students writing prompts that require them to read multiple informational texts in various forms (articles, info-graphs, videos, etc.) and create formal outlines, thesis statements, five-paragraph essays using parenthetical citations, and a works cited page. Assist them with each stage of the research and writing process as needed.
- Create broad topic prompt and have students research their own information, create their own theses, and write a five-paragraph essay following MLA format that supports their claims.

Research Simulation Task

- Provide notes, models, and support to craft an essay that compares the purposes of the three sources and analyzes how each source uses explanations, demonstrations, or descriptions to help accomplish its purpose with incorporated in-text citations and a Works Cited page.

Elements of Argumentative

- Using non-fiction texts with clear stances on a controversial topic, review main idea, thesis statements and author's purpose.
- Introduce vocabulary like claims, counterclaims, and rebuttals, and have students identify each within given non-fiction texts.
- Review elements of persuasive writing and differentiate between persuasive and argumentative techniques (use of counterclaims, etc). Provide reading comprehension quizzes using multiple-choice and open-ended questions.
- Research controversial topics of interest in groups; model Socratic seminar and rubric, watch videos to deepen understanding and expectation; students work collaboratively to prepare and deliver information, claims, and supporting evidence that is appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.

Argumentative Essay Writing

- Alternate between practicing close-reading skills of non-fiction texts of contrasting stances and writing argumentative paragraphs analyzing main ideas and claims and counterclaims, emphasizing the use of counterarguments that match the claims made before disproving them with solid evidence that supports thesis.

- Using the parts of the writing process, give students writing prompts that require them to read multiple informational texts in various forms (articles, info-graphs, videos, etc.) that have clear contrasting points of view on a given topic and have them create formal outlines, thesis statements, five-paragraph essays using MLA parenthetical citations, and a works cited page. Assist them with each stage of the research and writing process as needed, emphasizing the use of claims, counterclaims, and rebuttals to create strong and clear arguments.

Grammar:

- sentence structure
- commas
- redundancy
- punctuation
- pronoun-antecedent
- varied kinds of sentences

Vocabulary:

- Context clues
- Connotation/denotation
- Word parts
- Synonyms/antonyms

Suggested Study Sync Units

- Unit 3
- Parts of Unit 5
- Parts of Unit 6

Suggested IXL Lessons

- 7.C.2. Which sentence is more formal?
- 7.E.1-4 Text structure
- 7.H.1-3 Analyzing informational texts
- 7.I.1. Trace an argument
- 7.K.1-2 Analyze passages from *Anne Frank: The Diary of a Young Girl*
- 7.K.3-4 Analyze passages from *A Night to Remember*
- 7.M.2. Read graphic organizers
- 7.N.1-3 Expository Writing
- 7.O.1-4 Persuasive and opinion writing
- 7.Q.1. Identify supporting details in informational texts
- 7.T.1-5 Research skills
- 7.AA.5. Use academic vocabulary in context: informational
- 7.CC.1-5 Reference skills
- 7.RR.1-5 Commas
- 7.VV.1-4 Formatting

Reading and Analyzing Informational and Argumentative Texts:

- **Evidence-Based Selected Response Study Sync End-of-Unit - Grade 7 - Unit 3:** Students will close read multiple choice questions and possible answer choices, literal and inferential claims and pieces of cited textual evidence, to conclude accurate text-based selections. Questions will focus on informational and argumentative text structures.

Research Simulation Task:

- Students will be given three articles about a non-fiction topic and tasked with answering multiple-choice reading comprehension questions and writing an essay that compares the purposes of the three sources and analyzes how each source uses explanations, demonstrations, or descriptions to help accomplish its purpose with incorporated in-text citations and a Works Cited page.

Argumentative Socratic Seminar:

- Students will research a controversial topic and prepare talking points/claims with support to several different questions regarding both sides of the argument as well as propose questions about central ideas while using formal tone and language.

Summative:

- Quizzes/Quests
- Topic Tests & Essays

Formative:

- Classwork and Homework
- IXL Practice
- Teacher Observation
- Class Discussion
- Close-Reading and Annotating
- Peer Editing and Revising Using Rubrics
- Debates

Unit # 4	Duration: 1 Marking Period
Topic: Cumulative Review and Comparison of All Genres	
Alignment to NJSLs (include practice standards)	
● L.SS.7.1. ● L.KL.7.2. ● L.VL.7.3. ● L.VI.7.4. ● RL.CR.7.1. ● RI.CR.7.1. ● RI.IT.7.3.	

- RL.PP.7.5.
- RI.PP.7.5.
- RL.MF.7.6.
- RI.MF.7.6.
- RL.CT.7.8.
- RI.CT.7.8.
- W.AW.7.1.
- W.IW.7.2.
- W.NW.7.3.
- W.RW.7.7.
- SL.PE.7.1.
- SL.PI.7.4.
- SL.AS.7.6.

Technology, Career Awareness, and 21st Century Standards (NJSLS 9)

9.4.8.CI.2: Repurpose an existing resource in an innovative way (e.g., 8.2.8.NT.3).

9.4.8.CT.2: Develop multiple solutions to a problem and evaluate short- and long-term effects to determine the most plausible option (e.g., MS-ETS1-4, 6.1.8.CivicsDP.1).

Interdisciplinary Standards

9.4.8.CI.3: Examine challenges that may exist in the adoption of new ideas (e.g., 2.1.8.SSH, 6.1.8.CivicsPD.2).

Curriculum Requirements (N.J.A.C. 6A:8, 6A:30)

SL.II.7.2. Analyze the main ideas and supporting details presented in diverse media and formats (e.g., visually, quantitatively, orally) and explain how the ideas clarify a topic, text, or issue under study. Climate Change Example: Students may present data on the impacts that climate change has on New Jersey to inform the development of related technologies.

Learning Objectives and Activities

SWBAT answer the following questions:

- How does comparing texts across genres help us understand story structure?
- How and why do individuals, events and ideas interact in texts?
- In what ways do authors of different genres writing about the same topic develop similar themes?
- How does one effectively compare and contrast literature to its audio, filmed, or staged version?
- How does specific word choice and figurative language shape meaning and tone?
- How do specific parts of the plot relate to one another and contribute to the theme?
- In what ways do authors of fiction use or alter history to develop narratives?
- In what ways do poetry, narrative, and drama compare and contrast?
- In what ways do speakers of poetry develop their points of view, and how does that compare to narrators of fiction and characters in drama?
- How do poetic elements interact to create central ideas and themes?
- How does mood interact with character development and plot in dramas?

- How does point-of-view or purpose shape the content and structure of a text?
- How do major sections of informational texts contribute to the development of central ideas?
- In what ways can information presented in diverse media formats be analyzed and evaluated?
- What is the relevance of using digital media and visual aids to express information and create an engaging presentation?
- How can we present information, claims, and supporting evidence to listeners and participants in Socratic seminar?
- Why is following collegial discussion rules crucial for the completion of specific group goals and deadlines?
- How can we pose questions that elicit elaboration?
- How can we present information in a focused, coherent manner?
- In what ways can we demonstrate superior command of the conventions, mechanics, and usage of the standard English language in writing?
- How can we illustrate advanced proficiency of grade-appropriate vocabulary?
- How can we recognize and revise wordiness, redundancy, and flowery language in speaking and writing?
- How can audiences evaluate arguments and specific claims in text to assess sound reasoning?

SWBAT demonstrate understanding of the following:

Reading Comprehension Cumulative Review

- Narratives and Fiction
- Poetry
- Drama
- Informational Text and Structure
- Argumentative Evaluations
- Compare and Contrast Fiction and Non-Fiction Texts

Written Expression Cumulative Review

- Text-Based Narrative
- Literary Analysis
- Research Simulation
- Evaluating Arguments

Grammar:

- sentence structure
- commas
- redundancy
- punctuation
- pronoun-antecedent
- verb-tense agreement
- varied kinds of sentences

Vocabulary:

- Context clues
- Connotation/denotation
- Word parts

- Synonyms/antonyms

Learning Activities:

Literary Analysis that Compares and Contrasts

- Review elements of fiction, particularly character development, theme, and symbolism by close reading various works of fiction (novels, short stories, poetry, excerpts, movies, etc.)
- Given two works of fiction, use various types of prewriting (webs, t-charts, etc.) to compare and contrast elements of the stories (character, theme, symbolism, etc.) using strong direct citations.
- Given various works of fiction, have students compare and contrast elements of both stories by completing MLA formatted essays using strong evidence from both texts to support their claims.
- Providing two or more works of fiction for each prompt, have students create essays that determine the development of character, theme, or symbolism, etc. by comparing and contrasting elements of each text in well-supported paragraphs.

Cumulative Review of all Genres:

- Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge of reading: literature, informational, argumentative, drama, and poetry.
- See above curriculum and review using various texts and prompts for cumulative skill-based assessment of the seventh-grade year.

Close Reading Strategies:

- Identifying and highlighting central ideas (s), annotating
- Deciphering unknown words in context using context clues and knowledge of word parts (roots, prefix, suffix)
- Formulating questions, making predictions, connections, and inferences
- Analyzing use of and determining meanings of sound devices, figurative language, literary devices, imagery, mood, and tone

Central Ideas and Supporting Details:

- Explicit
- Inferential
- Theme development

Vocabulary in Context:

- connotation
- denotation
- context clues

Socratic Discussion:

- Answer and generate questions about each genre to create a class discussion.

Written Expression Cumulative Review

- Explain the meanings of words and phrases in a text, including figurative and literary meanings and connotations in short answer responses
- Compare and contrast how authors of different genres develop similar points of views
- Identify themes and illustrate their develop in multiple texts and genres (essay and open-ended)

- Compare and contrast theme development in two texts of different genres
- Plan, draft and publish text-based narratives from poem or drama anchor texts
- Demonstrate appropriate use of MLA format and Works Cited

Suggested Study Sync Units

- Unit 4
- Unit 6
- Parts of any previous units

Suggested IXL Lessons

- 7.B.1. Match quotations with their themes
- 7.C.3. Compare passages for tone
- 7.L.1. Compare information from two texts
- 7.L.2. Compare two texts with different genres
- 7.M.1. Compare illustrations of literary and historical subjects
- 7.N.3. Remove the sentence that does not belong
- 7.P.2. Create varied sentences based on models
- 7.R.2. Use parallel structure
- 7.R.3. Remove redundant words or phrases
- 7.S.5. Suggest appropriate revisions
- 7.V. 1-4 Greek and Latin Roots
- 7.W.1. Choose the synonym
- 7.W.2. Choose the antonym
- 7.Z.1. Analogies
- 7.Z.2. Analogies: challenge
- 7.PP.1-3 Misplaced modifiers
- 7.JJ. 1-3 Subject-verb agreement

Benchmark, Formative, Summative and Alternative Assessments

Reading and Analyzing Informational and Argumentative Texts:

- **Evidence-Based Selected Response Study Sync End-of-Unit - Grade 7 - Unit 6:** Students will close read multiple choice questions and possible answer choices, literal and inferential claims and pieces of cited textual evidence, to conclude accurate text-based selections. Questions will focus on all text structures.

Cumulative Yearly Review Written Expression Assessment:

- For each task, students will close read writing prompts, highlight central ideas, create plans to gather and organize information, then draft, revise, edit, and publish responses with formal MLA headings, titles, and Works Cited pages demonstrating superior command of the writing process in various genres.

Text-Based Narrative:

- Given a narrative or dramatic excerpt or a poem and a prompt, students will close read anchor texts and plan and organize a retelling of an/the events of plot through different narration and/or point-of-view or style.

Theme Development Essay Analysis of Multiple Texts:

- Given different genres, students will identify a common theme in multiple texts and illustrate its contrasting development in each by acknowledging text structure and point of view.

Evaluating Arguments:

- Given multiple sources that illustrate contrasting viewpoints (texts, videos, blogs, graphs, etc), students will evaluate the strength of each argument in a Socratic seminar and/or essays.

Research Simulation Task:

- Given two articles and a video, students must identify a comparative topic and central ideas and illustrate how each source uses contrasting evidence to develop them.

Summative:

- Quizzes
- Tests and Essays

Formative:

- Classwork and Homework
- Guided Practice Problems
- IXL Practice
- Teacher Observations
- Class Discussion
- Close-Reading and Annotating

Modifications (ML, Special Education, At Risk Students, Gifted & Talented, & 504 Plans**ML**

- Work toward longer passages as skills in English increase
- Use visuals
- Introduce key vocabulary before lesson
- Teacher models reading aloud daily
- Use of Bilingual Dictionary
- Guided notes and/or scaffold outline for written assignments

Supports for Students with IEPs:

- Allow extra time to complete assignments or tests

- Guided notes and/or scaffold outline for written assignments
- Work in a small group
- Allow answers to be given orally or dictated
- Use large print books, Braille, or e-books
- Follow all IEP modifications

At-Risk Students:

- Guided notes and/or scaffold outline for written assignments
- Introduce key vocabulary before lesson
- Work in a small group
- Lesson taught again using a differentiated approach
- Allow answers to be given orally or dictated
- Use visuals / anchor charts
- Leveled texts according to ability

Gifted and Talented:

- Create an enhanced set of introductory activities (e.g. advance organizers, concept maps, concept puzzles)
- Provide options, alternatives and choices to differentiate and broaden the curriculum
- Organize and offer flexible small group learning activities
- Provide whole group enrichment explorations
- Use center, stations, or contracts
- Organize integrated problem-solving simulations
- Propose interest-based extension activities
- Expose students to beyond level texts.

Supports for Students With 504 Plans:

- Follow all the 504 plan modifications
- Text to speech/audio recorded selections
- Amplification system as needed
- Leveled texts according to ability
- Fine motor skill stations embedded in rotation as needed
- Provide anchor charts with high frequency words and phonemic patterns